

MISSISSIPPI GULF COAST COMMUNITY COLLEGE

HARRISON COUNTY CAMPUS

COURSE OF STUDY

Date Revised: 26 January 2026

Course Number and Name: CSC 1123 – Computer Applications I -13 week Spring 2026

Department/Program: Mathematics/Computer Science

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Prerequisite: None.

Course Description: This course is designed to teach computer applications to include word processing, spreadsheets, database management, and presentation design. The course will also cover basic computer usage, file management, privacy and security, and artificial intelligence (AI), and will incorporate AI into some assignments.

DISCLAIMER: This syllabus may be subject to slight changes. Any important changes will be communicated clearly and immediately.

EDUCATION LEARNING OUTCOMES:

1. **Tenacity:** Students will demonstrate capacity to persevere despite difficulties and setbacks.

Skills Assessment: The student will receive a word processing assignment along with an instructor-supplied demonstration video. The student will benefit from the video and demonstrate the ability to persevere through a difficult assignment.

2. **Responsiveness:** Students will demonstrate the ability to be attentive, to be open to feedback, to be sensitive to changing circumstances, and to act appropriately as needed.

Skills Assessment: The student will design a minimum of two well-crafted prompts for an AI system that effectively captures information about the topic assigned.

3. **Critical reasoning:** Students will employ logical thinking to comprehend and analyze issues and make appropriate decisions.

Skills assessment: The student will use AI in a spreadsheet to analyze data. The data analysis will create summary reports and high-level visualizations such as tables or charts.

4. **Creative thinking:** Students will integrate knowledge and freely associate diverging ideas to generate novel solutions.

Skills Assessment: The student will successfully build a presentation software project that incorporates a minimum number of slides and images and may or may not use AI.

5. **Personal Responsibility:** Students will self-regulate in regard to time management, preparedness, emotional intelligence, and integrity.

Skills Assessment: The student will complete a database assignment that involves the creation of tables and queries with a set period of time to accomplish.

CONTENT OUTLINE:

- I. Application Software
- II. File Management
- III. Security and Privacy
- IV. Artificial Intelligence
- V. Microsoft Word
- VI. Microsoft Excel
- VII. Microsoft Access
- VIII. Microsoft PowerPoint
- IX. Integrated Office Projects2

REFERENCES/TEXTBOOKS:

BEFORE YOU PURCHASE: Students should already have access to Pearson eTextbooks for the required books in this class.. Read on for details:

- This course will require the following textbooks from Pearson: GO! Microsoft 365: All 2021 Edition by Gaskin, Vargas, Geoghan, and Graviett and Visualizing Technology: Tenth Edition by Debra Geoghan.
- Course materials and the e-book are included via Pearson+ and MyLab IT. Students should have automatic access if they are enrolled in the course. You will not need to purchase the textbook separately.
- Students should verify that they have access to course materials and complete the initial assignments using them within the first week of class. If you have any issues with this, please let me know immediately.
- Directions to access course materials will be given during class and provided on Canvas. Here is a brief summary:

Go to the course Canvas page and follow the Access Pearson link on the left side. Then go to the Pearson Course Home, go to Pearson eTextbook, open Pearson+, and open eTextbook

INSTRUCTIONAL METHODS:

The course content will be covered through lectures and hands-on lab exercises for the student. Assignments will allow students to demonstrate their understanding of the material, procedures, and techniques.

EVALUATION AND ASSESSMENT METHODS:

Final grades are based on a combination of assignments, quizzes, and tests, using the following 10-point scale:

Grading Scale

A = 90 – 100

B = 80 – 89

C = 70 – 79

D = 60 – 69

F = 59 and below

Bonus points may be added to a student's final grade if they have perfect attendance, are generally engaged and showing effort, and assist the instructor through feedback, questions, etc.

Unless stated otherwise, all assignments are due at 11:59 p.m. (just before midnight). Assignments will be due on Sundays and should always be available at least a week ahead of their due date, allowing you plenty of time to ask questions about assignments.

Always check Canvas for exact assignment dates. The course calendar will provide approximate assignment dates.

You will have at least one proctored test for this course. The proctored test(s) will either be administered via Respondus Lockdown Browser and will require a web camera, or they will be administered via Smarter Proctoring and will require you to be proctored in-person.

LATE WORK:

All late work will be accepted. For each day that an assignment is late, however, its grade will be reduced by 3%. If an assignment is turned in a week late, e.g., the grade will be reduced by 21% (7*3). Thus, missing an occasional deadline will not affect your grade much, but consistent failure to turn assignments in on time will severely impact your grade.

With a sufficient and documented excuse (like a doctor's note) I may extend due dates as necessary, but you should always let me know ASAP. I will not grant extensions for insufficient reasons; the late policy is lenient enough as it is.

COURSE REQUIREMENTS:

This course **REQUIRES** Microsoft Office 365 to include Microsoft Word, Excel, Access, and PowerPoint.

NOTE 1: Be sure you have downloaded and installed Office to your computer and are not just using Office 365 online.

You will not be able to complete all assignments using just online Office 365. As an MGCCC student, you are eligible to download MS Office for **FREE**. See instructions in the Course Information module.

NOTE 2: The full installation of Microsoft 365 is unavailable on a Chromebook, and Microsoft Access is unavailable on a Mac. If you have a Chromebook or Mac, you will have to get access to a Windows PC for those assignments which you are unable to complete. See the Course Announcements for further information.

ATTENDANCE:

This is an **online class**, and as a result attendance is defined as **active participation** in course learning. Thus, your class attendance will be measured weekly and will be based upon documentable engagement with course content. Failure to submit assignments on time for a week counts as an absence. Partial absences will also be given if some but not all work is submitted. If you are absent for **TWO** or more weeks (consecutive or non- consecutive, and summing partial absences), you will be dropped from the course. Bonus points may be earned towards your final grade if you have perfect attendance over the course of the semester.

NOTE: Simply logging into the course does not constitute participation in learning activities.

To avoid being dropped unexpectedly, always contact your instructor if you have extenuating circumstances that prevent you from completing assignments or tests. Active communication with your instructor will go a long way.

INDIVIDUAL HELP:

I cannot encourage you enough: if you need help, please reach out and ask! I am more than willing to help in any way I can (within reason), and if you put in the effort and proactively seek help when necessary I can almost guarantee you will do fine in the class.

I do not have an office on campus ,but I am available for online support through email and Canvas. If you need significant assistance, the best solution is always to get help in person, either in class or during my office hours. If you have a simple question, or can't come in person, send me an email directly at Kanika.willis@mgccc.edu, message me via Canvas, or if you feel it is necessary you may call me and leave a voicemail for me to return your call (be sure to leave a contact number).

My office hours will be 7pm-9pm Monday, Wednesday, and Thursday for recording lectures and providing any student assistance.

Again, I am happy to answer any questions and provide whatever assistance I can, but before reaching out with a question, always make sure that you have made an honest effort to answer the question yourself. For example, you should not need to ask a question if the answer is readily available in the syllabus or assignment directions. Also, try to be specific, clear, and direct with your problem so that I am best able to help you. Always tell me which class, which assignment, what step you are having trouble with, and what the problem is. If the assignment involves a file submission, I will typically need you to send me your file, so I can see what the problem is.

I also highly encourage study groups and other forms of peer collaboration. You should never directly copy a classmate's work (see below), but getting general guidance and help from your classmates is permitted. You may also utilize the

HELP Discussion board in Canvas, where your classmates may respond to your questions.

ACADEMIC HONESTY POLICY:

A hallmark of any profession is integrity and honesty. Academic honesty is expected of all students, and its importance cannot be understated. Each student is expected to accomplish his/her own work. Students will be given a grade of "0" on the given assignment for any first time act of academic dishonesty, including plagiarism. Students will be dropped from the course and given a grade of "F" for any second offense of academic dishonesty.

Academic Dishonesty includes copying and submitting another student's work OR finding the solution online and submitting it as your own work OR using any kind of AI tool to complete your work/give you the answer.

On select assignments, it is possible that I will allow you to use online resources or AI tools, but this will always be made abundantly clear and will usually require citation of these sources. You should always assume that they are not allowed unless otherwise stated.

I do allow you to help each other on assignments, as mentioned above, but there is a clear distinction between that and cheating. Here are a couple easy rules of thumb when helping/getting help from another student: Would I be fine with the teacher seeing me do this? Would the teacher give me this level of help if I asked them? If you ever have any doubts about whether something counts as Academic Dishonesty, please ask me. It is not a legitimate excuse to say "oh, I didn't realize this was cheating!"

REASONABLE ACCOMMODATION:

Compliance with section 504 of the Rehabilitation Act of 1973, the Americans with Disabilities Act, Title II of the Age Discrimination Act, and Title IX of the Education Amendments of 1972 are coordinated by the Compliance Officer, Perkinston Campus, P. O. Box 609, Perkinston, Mississippi 39573, telephone number 601- 528-8735, email address compliance@mgccc.edu.

Prospective students who require special and reasonable accommodation(s) because of physical or mental impairment must make their needs known prior to enrollment at Mississippi Gulf Coast Community College. Prospective students must follow the guidelines in the college catalogue. If you have a disability of any kind and will need reasonable accommodations or assistance in the classroom or with this course, please see the instructor the first day of attendance.

<https://mgccc.edu/enroll/apply-now/students-with-disabilities/disability-accommodations/>

EQUAL OPPORTUNITY:

Mississippi Gulf Coast Community College is an Equal Opportunity Employer and welcomes students and employees without regard to race, religion, color, national origin, sex, pregnancy, age or qualified disability in its programs and activities.

For further information, contact the Compliance Officer, P.O. Box 609, Perkinston, Mississippi 39573, telephone number. O. Box 609, Perkinston, Mississippi 39573, telephone number 601-528-8735, email address compliance@mgccc.edu.